of those outside the true religion, with the Word of God acting as the soul-piercing sword.

Further, the ‘scientific temper’ that arose out of the Enlightenment may have actually provided ‘scientific’ justifications for the race consciousness and perceived superiority of the White Christian European coloniser, as distilled from the writings of Kant himself. There is enough literature to suggest that at least until 1795, when Kant completed the manuscript of *Toward Perpetual Peace* at the age of 71, he consciously and openly believed in the hierarchy of races, and in particular, the superiority of the Whites over the non-Whites. In 1788, he was of the view that people from Africa and India lacked the drive to activity, and hence lacked the mental capacities to be self-motivated and successful in northern climates.[33] To him, the Native Americans were weak, inert, incapable of any culture and occupied the lowest rung of the racial hierarchy. For someone who is credited with the formulation of a universalist moral theory, until the age of 71, Kant’s belief that the Whites represented the perfection of humanity was writ large in his writings. At the very least, it calls into question the views expressed by Kant during this period on a host of topics, such as equality and morality, when he published some of his most seminal works, such as the *Critique of Pure Reason* (1781).

In fact, Kant’s views on race were consistent from 1764, when he was 40 years of age, until 1795. In *Observations on the Beautiful and the Sublime* (1764), he wrote that the black colour of a ‘negro carpenter’ proved the stupidity of whatever he said and that the difference in the mental faculties of the Whites and Blacks was as large as the difference in their colours.[34] On the Hindus, he was of the view that they were superior to the ‘Negroes’ because they could be educated but only in the arts and not in the sciences and other subjects that required powers of abstraction. Of course, there are those who believe that his subdued approach on race post 1795, after a lifetime of belief in a racial hierarchy and White superiority as a scientific fact, was proof of a change of heart.[35] What such apologists fail to understand is that the brunt of Kant’s race-driven morality during his prime years and those of other Enlightenment thinkers was borne by indigenous societies because the best minds of the Enlightenment were comfortable offering pearls of wisdom to the entire world on morality and equality while openly wearing their White Christian supremacy on their sleeves. Obviously, this casual Janusian approach reflected in the conduct of the